

file analysis allow it to outsource its special effects tools keeping it light weight. It must be said that Wavosaur isn't very likely to win any beauty contests for its layout and style. With a barebones visual layout it allows for only the essentials like docking and floating of panels in a plain colour scheme. But given its immense power, speed and variety of functionality Wavosaur is a worthy choice for any audio editor.

Image

When we consider apps for this discussion we're looking for that application which brings us closest to the needs for multimedia editing. Software that can match up best with paid for industry standard apps like Photoshop are rare, often times only providing easy to use basic functionality that is significantly limited once you start to make detailed and subtle changes. We've jumped right into this category with help from the open source community's long standing response to Photoshop and added in a darkhorse application that will come as a surprise for many.

GIMP

Get it at: <http://www.gimp.org/downloads/>

Run it on: Linux, Mac and Windows

For the longest time the flame wars on the internet between Photoshop users and open-source GIMP users inevitably would lead to the shutting down of threads. The open source community would inevitably be left wanting due to the limitation of non-proprietary tools but with recent iterations of the GNU development they finally have a Image Manipulation Program or GIMP which can match up to Photoshop. Now available on Mac and Windows as well, GIMP has simplified the learning curve and is as easy to use as Photoshop, not to mention with open sourced plug-ins it can infact out do Photoshop in many photo-processing adjustments. GIMP has a similar interface as Photoshop with a new twist in the mix of how toolbar, layer and adjustment panels are oriented on the screen. In fact the user interface is very moddable to suite any users workflow needs. It also singles out Color adjustments as a single option making it far easier to make changes to images. The preset scripts for various image adjustments are remarkably powerful giving clean edits without any pixel artifacts. The only lacking aspect is its vector/raster Text abilities which are not nearly as good as Photoshops. The ability to work with RAW photograph formats is separated as an add-on and needs to be set up using UFRaw which is also an open-source application